

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦7

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦Q

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣K

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥4

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣K

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 10 6 3

♥ Q J

♦ 9 8 5

♣ Q 7 3

♠ A 8 7

♥ 10 9 8 6 3

♦ A 6 2

♣ A 8



♠ Q 5 2

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 10 7 4

♣ J 10 5 4

♠ 9 4

♥ A K 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ K 9 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♦ 7

NORTH has 13 points so he must open. He has five ♥s so he should open 1 ♥.

SOUTH, with 14 points and four ♥s knows there are enough points for a game contract and at least nine ♥s between the partners. She who KNOWS, GOES, so SOUTH bids 4 ♥.

This is similar to Deal 13.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 8 2
♥ Q 8 4 3
♦ K 7 4
♣ K Q 2

♠ A 10 7 3

♥ 10 2

♦ 9 6 3

♣ 10 9 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9

♥ A K J 6 5

♦ A 10 5

♣ A 7 6

♠ J 6 5 4

♥ 9 7

♦ Q J 8 2

♣ J 8 4

EAST has 20 points, a pretty strong hand to open
1♥.

WEST has 12 points, and makes a Limit Raise, a
jump to 3♥.

EAST is very, very close to bidding a slam. But she
knows WEST has 12 points at most, so she should
take the safe position and just bid 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

4♥

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♦Q

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K
♥ 7 5 2
♦ 10 7 2
♣ A K J 4 3 2

♠ Q 9 8 7 4 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 8 6

♣ 9 5



♠ 10
♥ A 8 6 4
♦ K J 9 3
♣ Q 10 8 7

♠ A J 6 5 3

♥ J 10 9

♦ A Q 5 4

♣ 6

NORTH passes to start with since he only has 9 points.

SOUTH naturally opens 1 ♠ with her 13 point, 5-card ♠ suit hand.

NORTH might now make a Limit Raise since his hand is now worth 11 points because of the two doubletons. However, with six trumps he should jump all the way to 4 ♠.

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 9 7 5 3

♥ Q 7

♦ A K 3

♣ K 2

♠ K 4

♥ 8 6 4 3

♦ J 7 5 2

♣ A 8 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 2

♥ K 5 2

♦ 8 6

♣ Q 7 6 3

♠ 6

♥ A J 10 9

♦ Q 10 9 4

♣ J 10 9 5

West

1 ♠

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ 4

North

Pass

East

2 ♠

South

Pass

WEST has 20 points, counting two extra for the fifth and sixth ♠s. Naturally she opens 1 ♠.

EAST has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. He has four of partner's ♠s so he responds 2 ♠.

WEST KNOWS that $6 + 20 = 26$, so she GOES to 4 ♠.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 10 9 3 2

♥ 10 9

♦ A 10 4

♣ 9 7 2

♠ A 7 4

♥ A J 8 7 2

♦ K Q J

♣ A 3



♠ Q 6 5

♥ 6 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K Q J 8 5

♠ J 8

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 9 7 5 3

♣ 10 6 4

NORTH has 20 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♥ rather than 2NT.

SOUTH barely has enough points for a response, but she does have four ♥s. So she responds 2♥.

NORTH adds SOUTH's 6 to his 20 and bids the game, 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♣K